

The lossmeme package

Typesetting the *Loss* meme symbol in L^AT_EX

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2026/06/05 v1.0

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1 Introduction

The loss meme package provides a single command, `\Loss`, which typesets the *Loss* meme symbol inline using TikZ.

Loss is a 2008 webcomic strip by Tim Buckley [1] that became an enduring internet meme, widely reproduced in minimalist abstract form as four line-art panels. This package provides a faithful minimal rendering suitable for use in L^AT_EX documents of all kinds.

2 Requirements

The package requires tikz, which is part of the pgf bundle, available on all standard T_EX distributions.

3 Usage

Load the package in the preamble:

```
\usepackage{lossmeme}
```

Then use the `\Loss` command anywhere in the document body.

`\Loss` `\Loss` takes no arguments and produces the symbol inline, automatically aligned to the text baseline. Example:

This result is dedicated to `\Loss`.

which produces:

This result is dedicated to $\text{\Loss}$.

The symbol scales naturally with the surrounding font size:

small: $\text{\Loss}$ normal: $\text{\Loss}$ large: $\text{\Loss}$ Large: $\text{\Loss}$ huge: $\text{\Loss}$

4 Implementation

The symbol is drawn entirely in *TikZ*. The four panels represent the four scenes of the original strip in a conventional minimalist encoding, reproduced here with vertical lines denoting standing figures and a horizontal bar denoting a prone figure.

```
\newcommand{\Loss}{%
  \begin{tikzpicture}[baseline=-0.6ex, x=0.6em, y=0.6em, line width=0.06em]
    \draw (0.0, -1) -- (0.0, 1);
    \draw (-1, 0) -- (1, 0);
    \draw (-0.7,-0.7) -- (-0.7, 0.7);
    \draw (-0.35, 0) -- (-0.35,-0.7);
    \draw (0.35,-0.5) -- (0.35, 0.7);
    \draw (0.15,-0.5) -- (1, -0.5);
    \draw (0.7, 0) -- (0.7, 0.35);
  \end{tikzpicture}%
}
```

5 License

This package is released under the [LaTeX Project Public License, version 1.3c](#) or later.

References

- [1] Tim Buckley, *Ctrl+Alt+Del*, strip of 2008-06-02. <https://cad-comic.com/comic/loss/>